COMMODORE 64 · DISK

THE WORLD OF STRONKIE

A sci-fi adventure in 17 parts



CREATED BY MARK STRONKS
AKA STRONKIE (C) 2026

WELCOME, PILOT

You are holding the manual for **The World of Stronkie**, an illustrated text adventure for the Commodore 64. It starts on a stormy night at a lonely manor and ends somewhere very, very far from home.

This package contains everything a well-prepared adventurer needs. Read the manual first; study the other items whenever you like. Some of them may come in handy.

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> The feelies look best printed on thick paper. Cut out the buckazoid note and the fragment log. The buckazoid note will not, sadly, buy you anything in the game.

THE STORY SO FAR

Your uncle Edmund was always the odd one in the family. While everybody else had normal jobs, he locked himself up in Ravenmoor Manor with his telescopes, his old books and a family amulet that nobody was allowed to touch.

Then, one morning, a letter arrives. Just a few hurried lines: *"Come to Ravenmoor at once. I have found it."*

Nobody has seen him since.

Now, on a stormy night, you stand at the iron gates of his manor. The windows are dark. The wind howls through the garden. And somewhere in that old house, your uncle is waiting, if he is still there at all.



The road to Ravenmoor Manor. Something flutters across the sky.

What happens next is up to you. Find your uncle, find out what he found, and perhaps find a whole lot more than you bargained for: a starship, a talking computer, space pirates, a planet that was lost long ago, and a man called Commander Vex.

GETTING STARTED

LOADING

The game comes on two disk sides. Put **side A** in drive 8 (a 1541, a 1571, an SD2IEC or an emulator such as VICE) and type:

`LOAD"*",8` then `RUN`

The title screen appears with music while the first part loads. When the bottom text says `N: NEW GAME L: LOAD GAME` and the border starts to flash, you are ready.

- Press `N` (or RETURN) to start a new game.
- Press `L` to continue a saved game.

Later in the adventure the game asks you to **insert the other side**. Turn the disk over and press a key. Both sides can start the game.

THE SCREEN

The top of the screen shows a picture of where you are. Below it is the **status line**, then the text of the story, and at the bottom the line where you type.

STATUS LINE	MEANS
`PROLOGUE 1`	the part you are playing
`*03/16`	star fragments found
`SCORE 0120`	your score (1070 is the maximum)
`MOVES 0042`	commands you have typed

When the text is longer than the screen, the game waits with `-- PRESS A KEY FOR MORE --`.

Hold RUN/STOP and press RESTORE to leave the game completely.

TALKING TO THE GAME

You play by typing short commands and pressing RETURN. Most commands are a **verb** and a **noun**:

`TAKE LAMP`
`OPEN DOOR`
`EXAMINE STATUE`
`TALK TO ROGER`
`GIVE FISH TO CAT`
`USE KEY`

The game only looks at the **first four letters** of every word, so `EXAM` works as well as `EXAMINE`. Little words like THE, A, AN, AT and TO are skipped.

MOVING AROUND

Type a direction: `N` `S` `E` `W` for north, south, east and west, and `U` or `D` for up and down. You can also type `GO NORTH` or `NORTH`. Every room tells you its exits.

HANDY SHORTCUTS

TYPE	TO
`L`	look around again
`I`	see what you are carrying
`G`	do the last command again
`TAKE ALL`	pick up everything here
`DROP ALL`	put everything down
`MAP`	see a map of this part (page 8)
`HELP`	a short list of commands
`HINT`	a clue, for 3 points (page 9)
`SCORE`	your score and star fragments
`MUSIC`	music on or off

USEFUL VERBS

Not sure what to try? These are some of the verbs the game understands. Not every verb works on everything, but trying never hurts. Well. Almost never.

TAKE / GET	DROP	EXAMINE / LOOK AT
OPEN	CLOSE	UNLOCK
PUSH	PULL	TURN
READ	SEARCH	DIG
GIVE	SHOW	TALK TO
USE	INSERT	PUT
LIGHT	WEAR	EAT / DRINK
CLIMB	JUMP	SWIM
BREAK	FILL	POUR
SAY	BUY / PAY	FIX / REPAIR
PRESS	PLAY	WAKE

TALKING TO PEOPLE

You will meet uncles, janitors, salesmen, pirates, inventors and a ship's computer with opinions. `TALK TO` them, more than once. `SHOW` them things and `GIVE` them things. People in this game remember what you did for them.

SAYING THINGS

Sometimes you have to say something out loud. Type `SAY` followed by the word, for example `SAY HELLO`.

> If the game doesn't understand a word, it tells you which one. Try another word for the same thing: a *LANTERN* may well be a *LAMP*.

SAVING AND LOADING

Save often. The universe is a dangerous place.

Type `SAVE` or press `F3`. The game asks `WHICH SLOT? PRESS 1, 2 OR 3`. Each slot keeps one saved game, so you can keep three moments of your adventure at the same time, for example one before a risky decision.



The game is saved under the name of the part, in the slot you chose.

To continue later, type `LOAD` or press `F1` and pick the same slot. From the title screen, press `L`. Press any other key at the slot question to cancel. The saved games live on the disk side you are playing, so keep the disk **not** write-protected.

FUNCTION KEYS

`F1`	load a saved game (the game asks if you are sure)
`F3`	save the game
`F5`	music on or off
`F7`	quit to the title screen

WHEN YOU DIE

It happens. The game shows how, makes a joke at your expense, and asks `TRY THIS PART AGAIN (Y/N)?` Press `Y` to restart the part you were in.

THE MAP

Lost? Type **MAP** to see a map of the part you are in.



The map of the grounds of Ravenmoor, early in the game.

ON THE MAP	MEANS
GARDEN	yellow: you are here
WELL	white: you have been here
?????	a place you haven't visited yet
— |	a way from one place to another

Some places are secret. They don't show up on the map until you have found them yourself. Some passages are so twisty that nobody can map them. You'll know them when you see them.

> The map only shows the part you are playing. Real adventurers draw their own map of the whole game on squared paper. It's half the fun.

POINTS AND STARS

You score points for solving puzzles, finding important things and doing clever (and sometimes kind) things. The maximum is **1070 points**. Type `SCORE` to see how you are doing.

STAR FRAGMENTS

Hidden throughout the game are **16 star fragments**. They are not always needed to go on, but they matter. Find all 16 and you will see the **true ending**. Keep track of them on the star fragment log in this package.

CHOICES THAT MATTER

Some things you do early in the adventure change what happens much later: who helps you, and which way through is open. You can always finish the game, whatever you chose. But a little kindness goes a long way, even in space.

HINTS

Stuck? Type `HINT`. If there is a clue for where you are, the game gives it to you, at the price of **3 points**. If not, it tells you to look around and examine everything, which is good advice anyway.



The cockpit of the STARRAVEN. NOVA, the ship's computer, is waiting.

ADVICE FOR NEW ADVENTURERS

- **Examine everything.** Then examine it again. Descriptions hide clues.
- **Read everything.** Signs, books, letters, labels. Even this manual.
- **Take everything** that isn't nailed down. If it is nailed down, look for something to un-nail it with.
- **Talk to everyone**, and come back to talk again after something has changed.
- **Combine things.** A thing that is useless on its own may be very useful with something else.
- **Draw a map.** Write down what you found where.
- **Save before you do something risky.** You have three slots: use them.
- **Try silly things.** The game has a sense of humour, and many famous adventures have left their mark on it. Old adventurers may find a few familiar words that still work.
- **Don't panic.** And always know where your towel is.



The village square. The locals are friendly, if you can understand them.

CREDITS

CREATED BY

Mark Stronks

AKA STRONKIE

MENU MUSIC

"Contest Demo (part 4)"
by Sami Seppä (Rock)
© 1988 Finnish Gold

STARRING

Uncle Edmund · NOVA, the ship's computer · Pip
Roger the janitor · Ensign Ricky · Captain LeChuckle
Elder Zooma · Stan · Victor · Ken
Commander Vex · and the Stronkies

SPECIAL THANKS

Sierra On-Line, Lucasfilm Games and Infocom,
for years of adventures.

IN MEMORY OF

Sir Patrick Stewart, 1940 – 2026

THE WORLD OF STRONKIE (C) 2026 MARK STRONKS
GITHUB.COM/STRONKIE/WORLD-OF-STRONKIE

Ravenmoor Manor, Tuesday night

My dear nephew (or niece; forgive an old man, I never could keep track),

Forty years I have searched. Forty years of people laughing at the old fool with his telescopes. They will not laugh any more. The old family stories about the stars were true, every word of them.

I cannot write more. I believe the house is being watched. There are men in grey uniforms in the village, asking questions about me.

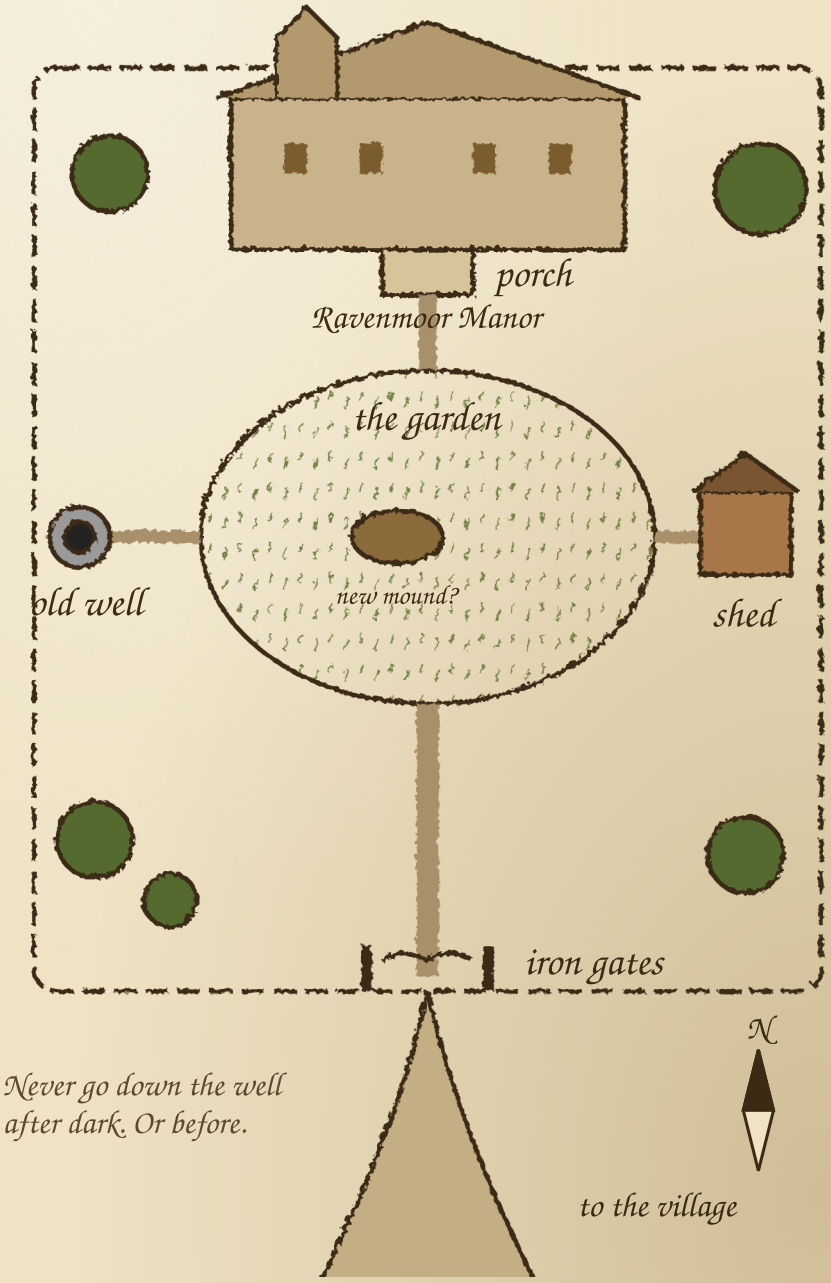
Come to Ravenmoor at once. I have found it.

Your uncle Edmund

P.S. The amulet knows the way. Trust nobody in uniform. And bring a warm coat: the heating has not worked since 1974.

The Ravenmoor Estate

as surveyed by E., in a hurry



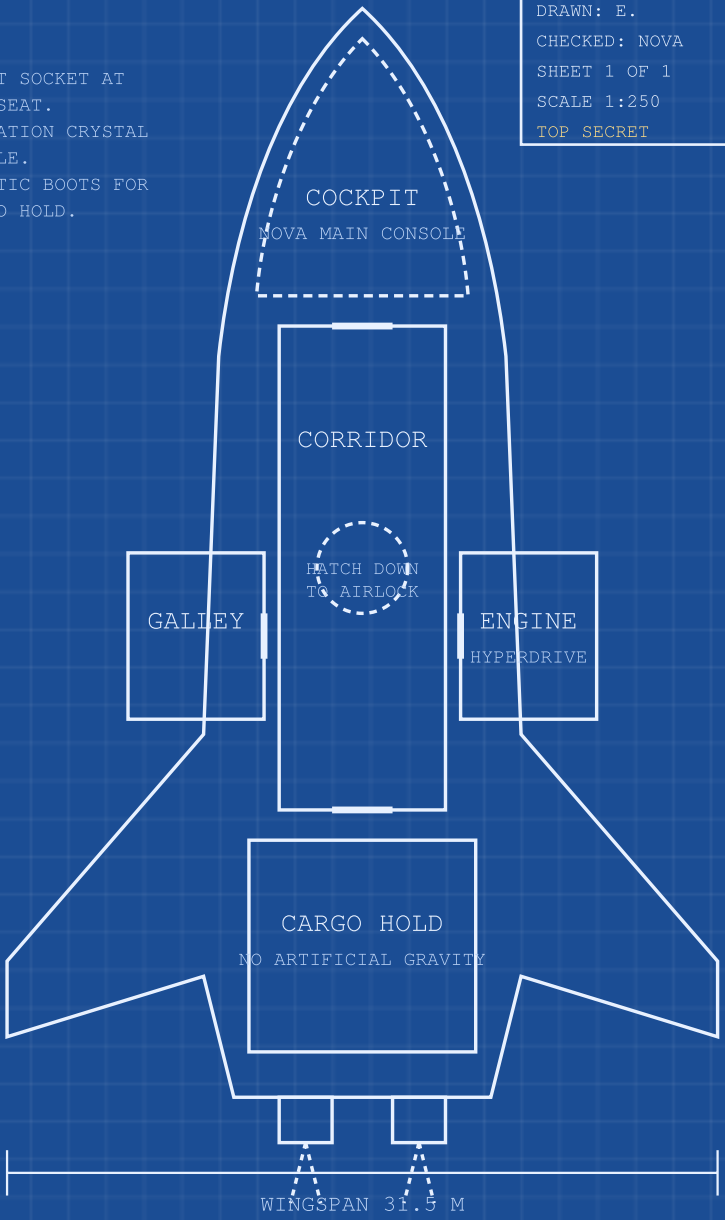
Never go down the well after dark. Or before.

STARRAVEN

RAVEN-CLASS SCOUT · GENERAL ARRANGEMENT · MAIN DECK, TOP VIEW

DRAWN: E.
CHECKED: NOVA
SHEET 1 OF 1
SCALE 1:250
TOP SECRET

NOTES:
1. AMULET SOCKET AT PILOT'S SEAT.
2. NAVIGATION CRYSTAL IS FRAGILE.
3. MAGNETIC BOOTS FOR THE CARGO HOLD.



WELCOME TO

SPACE PORT 42

*The most wretched hive of scum and villainy this side of Andromeda!**

THE SCUMM BAR

Bubbling grog, salty pirates and live music every night by the Two Guys from Andromeda. They are always on stage. Always.

STAN'S STARSHIPS

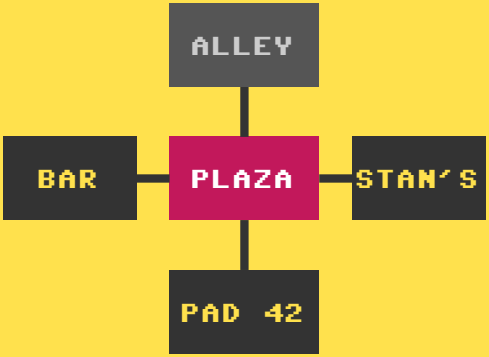
Fuel cells! Spare parts! A bargain bin! Prices out of this galaxy. Look for the loud jacket.

MONOLITH BURGER

Our famous burgers, served on the plaza. Napkins on request. Please request napkins.

THE ARCADE

Play Astro Chicken! Can you beat the all-time high score? (No. Nobody can.)



YOU ARE HERE: PAD 42

Visitors are kindly asked to stay out of the back alley. Lefty's is for members only. Members know the password. Ask Ken.

DON'T PANIC · HOLD ON TO YOUR TOWEL

*As voted by the readers of Wretched Hive Monthly, 23 years running. Space Port 42 accepts buckazoids only. Space Port 42 is not responsible for lost luggage, lost limbs, or ships towed by ghost pirates.

FEELIE 5 OF 6 · CUT ALONG THE DOTTED LINE

FIRST GALACTIC BANK OF ASTEROID 42

50

BUCKAZOIDS

50

Legal tender in all wretched hives of this sector

R. Wilco, Chief Treasurer (part-time)

No. 0042-1987 · IN STAN WE TRUST · Not valid at Stan's

STAR FRAGMENT LOG

Sixteen pieces of a fallen star are scattered across the worlds. Colour in a star for every fragment you find, and note where you found it.



No. 1



No. 2



No. 3



No. 4



No. 5



No. 6



No. 7



No. 8



No. 9



No. 10



No. 11



No. 12



No. 13



No. 14



No. 15



No. 16

Star fragments found	_____ / 16
Score	_____ / 1070
Moves	_____
Ending seen	☐ normal ☐ true

THE WORLD OF STRONKIE WILL RETURN...